

Evolution of a theme

By C.G.S.Narayanan

'Changes do happen to a theme substantially over the years when a two move idea is extended to three-move field because of having one more move which allows many discoveries and unbelievable flights of fancy' observes grandmaster Milan Vukcevic whose ambitious ideas coupled with his astounding technical skills turned out veritable masterpieces. Bristol and reciprocal changes were two of his favourite themes both in the two-mover and three-movers. In this article I present a few of his three-movers featuring reciprocal changes and Bristol evolved during different periods.

Milan Vukcevic

2 prize, Problem TT 1961



Mate in three moves

In the diagram above set mates are

1...Ra3(a) 2.Bd5+(A)Kd3 3.Qf3

1...Ba3(b) 2.Ne5+(B) Kc5 3.Qf8

After **key 1.Qa1!** (2.Qxa4) the

second moves of white are

reciprocally changed.

1...Ra3(a) 2,Ne5+(B) Kc5 3.Qxa3

1...Ba3 (b) Bd5+(A)Kd3 3.Qxa3

Let us study the classic below which Milan considers as one of his best three movers. In three-movers his Bristols turned out as successful as his reciprocal changes.

After the **key 1.Qc7!**(2.Rc4+ Rxc4 3.Qxc4) Black defends with self pinning captures on d3.1...Rxd3

2.Rc2!Bxc2/Rxc2/exd1Q

3.Qc3/Rxd3/Qc4and1...Bxd3

2.Bg3!Rxc3/Bxc3/exd1Q.Qf4/Rxd3/

Qe5

'These two variations each contain a self-pin, a Bristol, a Treffpunkt and an unpin. It came from the heart, unplanned as one huge mechanism with every gear fitting perfectly together'wrote Milan.

Milan Vukcevic

I prize, Stosic MT, 1982



Mate in three-moves

The problem for solving below has an aesthetic addition to the reciprocal change theme.

Milan Vukcevic

I prize,Diagrammes 1999



Mate in three moves

Solution to problem for solving in the article 'Black correction': **Key 1.Ra5!**

1...any 2.Rxa4+ Nb4 3.Rxb4;1..B

any 2.Qc2+ Kb4/Kxd4

3.Rxa4/Nf5;1..Bc6 2.Nc8

(Qc2+?)Rb1 3.Be2;1...Be6!! 2.Nxe8

Nc5 3.Rxc5;1...Be4!!!

2.Be6+(Qc2+?)/Nc8/Nxe8) Bd5

3.Bxd5

Readers may send in their queries to
cgsnarayanan@hotmail.com